Heritage in Motion

Of the many things that make India great, its traditional dance forms perhaps bring the most joy. Garba, the ancient folk dance typical of Gujarat, has just been inscribed by UNESCO on its Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity. Apart from its rhythmic style, catchy beats, and colourful costumes that brighten up the nine days of Navratri along with Dandiya (danced by all genders), Garba is special, as it is a devotional women-only dance that celebrates feminine energy. Its steps symbolise the womb (*garba*, in Sanskrit) and the power of Shakti.



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Capsule Collection

Heading to Prayagraj for the Magh Mela? January will see the installation of 60 high-tech capsule rooms at the Prayagraj Junction railway station in Uttar Pradesh. Expect complimentary wi-fi, phone charging points, well-maintained bathrooms, and locker rooms. Ten of the 60 affordable sleeping pods will be in a women's section, which will offer female travellers privacy and safety.

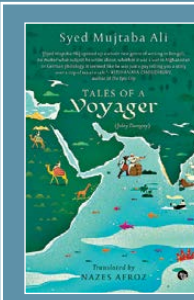
Price: Per 12 hours, single pods will cost ₹500, doubles for ₹1,000, and family pods for ₹1500.



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WORDS ACROSS THE WORLD

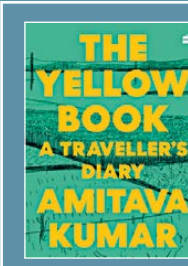
Three travelogues to bring you travel inspiration and unique insights.



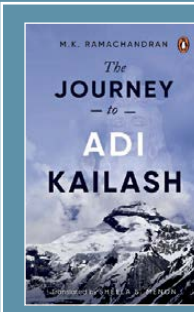
Tales of a Voyager (Joley Dangay) By Syed Mujtaba Ali Speaking Tiger ₹399; 200 pages

Bangladeshi author Syed Mujtaba Ali's travelogue is about his voyage from India to Europe decades ago. Translated by Nazes Afroz, it encapsulates all that a traveller wants in an epic journey. Although all true, it seems filled with magical realism thanks to the quirky characters he meets along the way, the colourful history that he interlaces with the stops, and his wicked sense of humour that spices up the narrative in all the right places.

Is it a diary? Is it a book? Whatever you call it, Amitava Kumar's writing is insightful and irresistible. Stemming from the post-pandemic need to record the times and find meaning in them, it is an outpouring of his observations through journaling and drawings while he travelled. Whether in the UK or India, even as world events affected him many ways, it's about the journey without as well as the one within.



The Yellow Book: A Traveller's Diary By Amitava Kumar HarperCollins ₹699; 216 pages



The Journey to Adi Kailash By M.K. Ramachandran Penguin India (Ebury) ₹599; 408 pages

Call him a prolific pilgrim or an avid author, M.K. Ramachandran has dedicated his life to travelling through the Himalayas, prostrating at the holiest spots, and writing about his many physical and spiritual journeys. In this one, translated by Sheela S. Menon, he brings to life the trek to Adi Kailash in Uttarakhand, weaving in his interpretations of ancient Hindu texts as well as fascinating local stories of people that he encountered en route.

Compiled by Priya Pathiyan